

Feminism

Feminism can be considered as a critical approach to traditional theories in which war, state and masculine have been associated. It is also that of ignoring the essential role of women by mainstream of IR. Accordingly, feminists make a distance from state-centric ideas to focus on gender build by social constructions. It shows that how power structures maintain the male visions and marginalize women. Feminism offers gender as a tool to analyzing power relations in international politics. Meanwhile, it proposes an alternative world order that must be more inclusive. Feminists have conducted the relationship between politics and gender since 1980s. they articulated that women's perspective (marginalized perspective) give a deeper insight to International Relations (Burchill et al., 2005; Griffiths, 2007).

Empirical feminism, analytical feminism, and normative feminism are the three approaches of feminism in IR. Empirical approach mentions studies in International Relations tend to perspective based on masculine domination instead of a comprehensive view with participation of women's experiences. Therefore, the understanding of global politics is partial. For instance, poverty and inequality as issues affect on women are not considered by neo-realism and neo-liberalism. The male bias in process of development resulted in inefficient outcome. Developing states are a good example where women take the key role to provide basic needs. The number of women in political officials compared to men demonstrates inequality while women leaders are more oppositions to

use of force. Rape was embedded in the Geneva Conventions as war crime thanks to women (Burchill et al., 2005).

Cynthia Enloe's work, *Bananas, Beaches and Bases*, refers to everyday practices of women that are intertwined with global systems. Global economy is one of them that shows this relation. For example, tourism uses women as workers or entertainers and also their pictures in advertising. Sex tourism is the other dimension of this industry, but global politics discusses oil and weaponry not tourism as a sector in which women play a crucial role (Griffiths et al., 2008).

Analysis reveals gender bias in the theoretical framework of IR. IR concepts bear gender meaning such as power, sovereignty, and security. Rationality is a male adjective. Normative feminism advocates for social and political change through feminist theorizing. Gender is about power structures at all levels of society not men versus women (Burchill et al., 2005).

Analysis

Evolution of feminism in IR can be traced from the point of women's experience. Lack of using the experience of women shows that the half of society has been put out of power relations. While women can participate in political affairs and create a comprehensive interpretation in IR. The second dimension is related to political issues that are masculine problems and marginalized sections that deal with women's condition. But progress goes beyond the physical presence of women or female issues. The attention to political concepts that attain masculine perspective has become the next step of revolution. It needs to redefine concepts in social context. Feminism is a young approach that needs to continue its path of evolution.

As Cynthia Enloe argues, some women like Margaret Thatcher help to maintain patriarchal power structure. The recognition of power dynamics as a sophisticated system is essential to critique

present order (Griffiths et al., 2008). Inequality is far than just based on gender. Race is the other dimension. How can we make an approach that counter to all elements of inequality. For example, in contemporary wars, women are damaged more than men but if the proportion of discrimination against a Ukrainian woman and a Syrian woman is equal?

Postcolonialism

IR has marginalized the voice of the south and has been a western-centric perspective by focusing on experiences of the west. The aim of postcolonialism is criticism of west-centric bias by unfolding and challenging relationship between power and knowledge that dominant world order. Postcolonial approach emphasizes marginalized components such as people, identities, and cultures instead of states and power dynamics. Post colonialists use some ideas from postmodernism in discourse, representation, and epistemological critiques areas and simultaneously enjoy Marxist ideas like Gramsci's concept of the 'subaltern' (Griffiths, 2007).

The feminist branch of postcolonialism critiques the view of western feminism that considers third world women as victimized and oppressed versus women from the west that are liberated. Indeed, the European lens as the center of world has been criticized by all clusters of postcolonialism. Edward Said by his orientalism claimed that Europe created a binary by placing orient versus itself. It is related to the power/knowledge dynamic in which European identity has become familiar and superior. Development is also considered as continuation of colonial discourses by which global south is deficient as underdevelopment. A pluralistic and flexible view of identity is promoted by postcolonial theory's emphasis on hybridity. By dismantling inflexible classifications and essentialist dichotomies, it imagines a world devoid of conflicting essences (Griffiths, 2007).

Critics contend that rather than speaking for the underprivileged and disenfranchised, postcolonial theory frequently reflects the concerns of affluent Third World scholars in Western academia. "Postcoloniality" is criticized by Arif Dirlik as a state that intellectuals experience when negotiating global capitalism. Nonetheless, postcolonial academics stress that their methodology aims to eliminate rather than strengthen boundaries and classifications (Griffiths, 2007).

Analysis

Postcolonialism tends to critique One-dimensional view in politics that rooted in western domination. Pluralization is the solution that puts aside struggle between two sides as good and weak perspectives. What is interesting is that participation of all voices in shaping the discourses of IR can lead to fostering of evolved process in IR. The key point in this evolution should be emergence fresh theories that have proposal for political phenomena or enrich current approaches. The path is fresh and the danger of radicalism, like ignoring practical and tested experiences and to the futile attempt to reinvent the wheel, is high. For example, to resolution of conflict between Ethiopia and Eritrea, it is not reasonable to lay just on traditional solution way because it is not enough to reach a sustainable peace. But we can combine traditional potential with ordinary methods to create a more powerful manner.

Bibliography

Burchill, S., Paterson, M., Reus-Smit, C., Linklater, A., Devetak, R., True, J., & Donnelly, J.

(2005). *Theories of International Relations, Third Edition*. Palgrave Macmillan.

<https://books.google.com.cy/books?id=QzGhAQAACAAJ>

Griffiths, M. (2007). *International Relations Theory for the Twenty-First Century: An*

Introduction. Taylor & Francis. https://books.google.com.cy/books?id=TKZ_AgAAQBAJ

Griffiths, M., Roach, S. C., & Solomon, M. S. (2008). *Fifty Key Thinkers in International*

Relations. Taylor & Francis. <https://books.google.com.cy/books?id=nu6SAAQBAJ>